

Alexander Oswald

Senior Game Data Analyst | Player Behavioural Analysis · Telemetry · Experimentation · Systems Modelling

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Game Data Analyst with 10+ years of experience in live-service games, with deep expertise in player behavioural analysis, telemetry event data, experimentation, data modelling, and the kind of careful data quality work that earns game teams' trust. Strongest at smaller studios where analytics had to be built, defended, and constantly justified — not inherited. The most durable wins came not from optimising short-term spend metrics but from diagnosing the structural problems everyone else was looking past: retention failures hiding behind short-term numbers, economy imbalances that quietly drove players away, social dynamics that determined whether a player stayed or left forever. Skilled cross-functional partner to Product, Design, Engineering, and Data teams, with strong SQL, Python, R, BI, and scalable analytics infrastructure experience. Drawn to games that earn loyalty rather than manufacture urgency — the ones players remember, return to, and tell their friends about without being asked. Sky is exactly that kind of game.

SKILLS & DOMAIN KNOWLEDGE

Programming SQL (Expert), Python, R, HiveQL, Bash

BI & Delivery Tableau, Looker (Enterprise LookML), Hex w/Jupyter Notebooks, RMarkdown, Amplitude, QuickSight, RShiny

Data Storage & Warehousing Snowflake, PostgreSQL, Redshift, SQL Server, Athena, S3, Glue, Parquet & Iceberg tables; GCP: BigQuery, Cloud Storage; NoSQL (Cassandra, MongoDB)

Cloud Platforms AWS (S3, Athena, Glue, Lambda, Firehose, EC2); GCP (BigQuery, Cloud Storage, Dataflow patterns); Azure (supporting exposure)

Data Tools & Platforms dbt, Airflow/Prefect, MLflow, Jenkins, Git/GitHub

Game Telemetry & Event Analytics Large-scale behavioural event log analysis, economy event streams (delta/balance events), NoSQL player record extraction, session and trade data at scale, PySpark distributed telemetry processing, anomaly detection on irregular-cadence events, telemetry data quality and coverage monitoring

A/B Testing & Experimentation A/B test design, cluster/community-level randomisation, switchback tests, quasi-experimental analysis, propensity score matching, difference-in-differences, guardrail metrics, SRM checks, network/spillover effects, uplift measurement

Game Systems Analytics Matchmaking quality, player progression, gameplay balance, economy shocks, content cadence, live-ops events, behavioural segmentation, retention/churn drivers, social network effects

Product & Player Analytics Player behaviour, engagement funnels, spend conversion, LTV forecasting, UA performance, long-term player health

ML Modelling & Personalisation Churn prediction, revenue forecasting, clustering, recommendation systems, multi-armed bandits, conversion modelling, anomaly detection

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

KEY VICTORIES

- Diagnosed a structural PvP retention failure at Kixeye everyone else was treating as a monetisation problem — built multi-objective models, simulated optimal defender configurations, and drove a retention lift of up to 2pp from D14 onward in mid-progression players, with incremental late-cohort revenue among returning spenders.
- Built and enforced a unified data model and KPI framework across Kixeye and Stillfront sister studios — where cross-studio accuracy was non-negotiable and Snowflake cost was a hard constraint; reduced warehousing costs 45% (~\$130K/year) while improving reporting trust across multiple game teams and executive stakeholders.
- Rebuilt Kano's analytics data model from the ground up — redesigned transformation architecture on dbt/Athena/Parquet/Iceberg, cut report refresh from 14 hours to under 1 hour, and restored stakeholder trust in reporting that had degraded under years of undocumented technical debt.
- Identified and corrected a \$14M overestimation in a game acquisition model before deal close.
- Used propensity score matching to save FIFA's Web App from discontinuation — providing the causal evidence base that secured ongoing investment in both companion platforms.

Kano Apps — Casual Games

Senior Game Data Engineer & BI Analyst · Victoria, BC Canada · May 2025 – Feb 2026

Hired to rebuild Kano's analytics data model from the ground up — redesigning transformation architecture using dbt and Athena on partitioned Parquet and Iceberg tables, enforcing data quality across migrated pipelines, and restoring stakeholder trust in reporting that had degraded under years of undocumented technical debt.

- Rebuilt the studio's player data transformation layer — migrating expensive R ETLs into optimised incremental dbt-Athena SQL models on partitioned Parquet and Iceberg tables, cutting daily report refresh from up to 14 hours to under 1 hour and reducing EC2 and Athena costs by 23%.
- Rebuilt and extended the event anomaly detection system in Python — expanding coverage to irregular-cadence live-ops events and improving the accuracy of behavioural signal monitoring that flags unexpected shifts in player activity, including patterns indicative of data integrity issues or abnormal player behaviour warranting investigation.
- Selectively applied LLM-assisted code translation to accelerate R-to-Python migration; manually refactored the remainder using deep bilingual R and Python expertise, preserving full analytical parity throughout.
- Migrated RShiny dashboards to QuickSight and replaced fragile cron-scheduled shell scripts with Prefect workflows, improving orchestration reliability, observability, and long-term maintainability.

Kixeye Inc — Mobile Games

Lead Data Analyst, Core Analytics Team Lead · Victoria, BC Canada · Feb 2022 – Jan 2025

Led Kixeye's Core Analytics Team while owning the data modelling and KPI standardisation work that unified reporting across multiple studios under Stillfront's shared infrastructure — where accuracy and cost were both hard constraints, not aspirations. While most analytical attention focused on near-term spend, the most durable wins came from diagnosing structural retention problems hiding in the numbers.

- Designed and enforced a unified KPI framework and data model across Kixeye and Stillfront sister studios — standardising definitions, ensuring cross-title analytical consistency, and delivering multi-studio reporting under significant Snowflake cost scrutiny; reduced warehousing costs 45% (~\$130K/year).
- Restored PvP viability for the player segment hit hardest by a thinning opponent pool — simulated optimal defender base configurations and generated progression-tiered bot-base specs for Design to author and Engineering to ship as A/B-testable content.
- Built and cross-validated three logistic models (PvP match-initiation propensity, expected economy sink, 7-day forward engagement) combined into a multi-objective score — driving a retention lift of up to 2pp from D14 onward in mid-progression players, with incremental late-cohort revenue among returning spenders.
- Built a long-term game revenue forecasting model in R and Python for an M&A; acquisition assessment — identifying and correcting a \$14M overestimation before deal close.
- Independently migrated Kixeye and Babil Games analytics dashboards onto Stillfront's shared Looker instance, saving \$90K annually and ensuring game teams had uninterrupted access to player reporting.
- Partnered with Stillfront sister studios to define shared KPI frameworks, build cross-game reporting, and deliver player behaviour analysis that informed multi-title cross-promotion strategies.
- Supported the migration of game analytics pipelines from GCP to AWS — contributing data modelling and analytical expertise as streaming and batch data flows were rebuilt using Firehose, Lambda, and Kinesis; developed working familiarity with GCP's data infrastructure (BigQuery, Cloud Storage) in the process.

Senior Product Analyst, Acting Core Analytics Team Lead · Victoria, BC Canada · Jan 2021 – Feb 2022

Acting Core Analytics Team Lead, collaborating with product and design teams across multiple live games on KPI definition, A/B reporting, content strategy analysis, and analytics workflows.

- Collaborated with the Design team to build a new content cadence strategy backed by funnel analysis and spend trend modelling, resulting in more predictable player engagement and reduced performance volatility across content releases.
- Used network analysis to show how alliances differed in their effect on member engagement, then partnered with Customer Service on solutions for tracking high-value players and alliance leadership.
- Helped the Design team discover and remediate multiple churn triggers related to progression, gameplay balance, and economy shocks using Bayesian logistic regressions when A/B tests were infeasible.
- Built an Alliance Recommendation Engine in Python, materially improving retention and increasing yearly revenue by 7% in concert with other improvements.
- Automated A/B test reporting and KPI forecasting ETLs, accelerating live-ops experiment readouts and freeing analyst capacity for higher-value work.
- Used logit regression models to confirm player disengagement from PvP, and elevated churn among PvP-centric player clusters due to issues with the ELO matchmaking system; partnered with Engineering on interim guardrails that reduced churn while a longer-term redesign was scoped.

Product Analyst, War Commander: Rogue Assault Team · Vancouver, BC Canada · Aug 2019 – Jan 2021

Originally hired to support the War Commander game team; pivoted early to urgent analytics and ML engineering needs before transitioning back to deeper player analytics work.

- Pulled and analysed large-scale player economy event streams (Lambda delta/balance events) using PySpark for distributed processing — an early introduction to working with raw telemetry at volume, requiring careful handling of event sequencing and

economy state reconstruction.

- Rebuilt core reporting and optimised legacy SQL workflows for Tableau and Looker in the first three months, restoring stakeholder trust in reporting that had degraded under accumulated technical debt.
- Significantly improved player LTV and revenue forecast accuracy for War Commander, giving the live-ops team more reliable models for UA spend planning and content investment decisions.
- Assessed how 3rd-party UA strategy was hurting early game retention, and successfully proposed a revised strategy that helped Facebook campaigns become profitable in 90 days instead of 200.
- Migrated ML pipelines and revenue attribution SQL from Domino to local Jenkins machines using PySpark for parallel processing and batch model scoring, cutting monthly platform costs by \$27K.
- Reworked the game's spend attribution modelling using SQL, PySpark, and Looker to more accurately diagnose economy and engagement drivers — generating a wave of new insights and major strategy shifts.

Electronic Arts — AAA Games

Data Scientist, Dynamic Experiences Team · Burnaby, BC Canada · Nov 2018 – Jul 2019

Helped establish a Data Science team embedded within EA Sports live teams to deliver more personalised player experiences through A/B testing and machine learning.

- Proposed, designed, and evaluated A/B test live-ops messaging campaigns for FIFA — using R, SQL, and HiveQL to measure personalisation lift across in-game player touchpoints.
- Identified FIFA player segments with the highest upsell responsiveness, targeting live-ops messaging to those cohorts and contributing to a 3% spend increase across targeted players.
- A/B experimentation on FIFA 19 live-ops messaging generated an additional \$2M in revenue — a direct outcome of personalised in-game communication design and rigorous experiment evaluation.
- Built multi-armed bandit messaging recommendation engines in Ruby for FIFA 20 personalisation.
- Developed new-player churn, pack spend conversion, and reacquisition prediction models in R to support recommendation systems and guide player reactivation efforts.

Business Analyst, FIFA Player Analytics Team · Burnaby, BC Canada · Jun 2016 – Nov 2018

Owned executive reporting, player engagement analysis, and licensing analytics for FIFA, while extending analytical coverage to Motive, BioWare, and DICE studios.

- Applied propensity score matching in R to measure the true engagement and spend lift from FIFA's Companion and Web Apps — providing the causal evidence base that saved the Web App from discontinuation and secured ongoing investment in both platforms.
 - Incremental spending gains of 4.2% (Web App) and 7.0% (Mobile App) among spenders, leading to millions in incremental revenue. Presented findings at EA's 2018 Analyticon conference.
 - Findings influenced the Madden team to develop a companion app for Madden 19.
- Extracted and analysed large-scale FIFA player trade records from NoSQL storage using early RSpark (Scala) — first hands-on exposure to processing raw event-level player data at AAA scale.
- Delivered monthly game performance insights and behavioural analysis for EA Sports titles to executive stakeholders, earning expanded reporting responsibility for Motive, BioWare, and DICE studios.
- Built modelling frameworks measuring the revenue impact each sports licence generated for EA and the brand exposure value returned to partners, informing smarter procurement and renewal decisions.

Pretio Interactive — Ad Tech Startup

Data Scientist · Victoria, BC Canada · Jul 2015 – Feb 2016

- Owned statistical research and ad-hoc analysis for a reward-based ad-network startup; built probabilistic conversion models and extracted MAB exploration data from an EpsilonGreedy algorithm, building self-service Mode reports for the sales team in a live environment.

TinyMob Games — Indie Game Startup

Data Analyst, TinyRealms · Victoria, BC Canada · Nov 2014 – Jul 2015

- Identified a player segment with elevated early churn, attributed it to a gameplay balance issue, and collaborated with game design on targeted fixes — improving D7 retention from 11.3% to 14.2% in the affected cohort of TinyMob's first F2P mobile game.
- Diagnosed the root cause of Tiny Realms' F2P economy failure: a structural free-rider dynamic in the game's co-op economy where players could benefit from others' spending without converting themselves.

Savepoint Analytics — Game Analytics Consulting

Founder & Principal Analyst · Victoria, BC Canada (Remote) · Mar 2026 – Present

Founded an independent game analytics consultancy serving indie and scaling studios that lack internal analytics capacity — covering the full range of decisions a first analytics hire would own.

- Advising studios on telemetry event selection and schema design, balancing analytical coverage with game-agnostic structures built for long-term reusability.
 - Designing analytics platform architectures using AWS, dbt, and modern BI tooling appropriate for lean game teams without dedicated data engineering resources.
 - Developing reusable KPI frameworks and data modelling standards tailored to F2P live-service game contexts.
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EDUCATION

M.A. in Economics — Auctions & Experimental Economics

University of Victoria · Victoria, BC Canada · 2011 – 2014

- Focused on auctions, game theory, experimental economics, and behavioural economics.
- Teaching assistant for two years for Game Theory, Natural Resource, and Micro/Macroeconomics.
- Published and co-authored Master's Thesis research that helped optimise timber lot auctions in Quebec.
(<http://www.cirano.qc.ca/files/publications/2015RP-05.pdf>)
- Awarded Phillips, Hager and North Master Degree Scholarship for Research in Environmental and Resource Economics.

B.Sc. in Economics — Minor in Mathematics

Illinois State University · Normal, IL United States · 2006 – 2010